

Review 2

Speaking and Vocabulary

A Answer these questions with a partner.

1. Do you feel that your speaking is generally improving?
2. Do you know what kind of questions the examiner will ask you in each part of the exam?
3. Do you feel more confident about answering those questions?

B The questions below practise the topics that you learnt in Units 6–10. Work in pairs. One of you is student A, the other is B. Ask and answer with your partner.

Student A

1. What do you like about the town or city you live in?
2. Do you prefer a city lifestyle or a more rural lifestyle?
3. How do you usually travel around your town or city?
4. Do you usually have enough time to do all the things you want to do each day?
5. Do you like shopping?
6. What makes you happy?

Student B

1. What is the most beautiful city you have visited?
2. Does your town or city have good facilities for entertainment and leisure activities?
3. How often do you fly? Do you enjoy flying?
4. How do you usually spend your free time?
5. When it comes to money, are you a saver or a spender?
6. What annoys you or makes you really angry?

C Write important words and phrases that you have learnt in Units 6–10 under each heading.

places

city and country life

travel and transport

feelings

my words and phrases

time expressions

money

say how often you do something

Listening and Reading

The thoughts below are from the 'exam tips' in the reading and listening sections of Units 6–10.

A Complete each sentence about listening, using one word only.

1. When I am listening for specific information, like writing names of places on a map, the speaker will often _____ information that I need to answer a question.
2. Sometimes I will have to complete a short _____ of what I heard on the tape. I need to spell words correctly and make sure they _____ grammatically. However, if I'm not sure how to fill a space, I should write what I think I hear.
3. Having a table will help when I listen, because I can predict how the talk will be organized and _____ into parts. I will know that the speaker is going to move to a new topic within the talk.
4. I will sometimes need to understand the meaning of a key word I don't know from the context. I might have to _____ the spelling of a new word if it is part of an answer.
5. If a task asks me to classify, I will need to read the _____ carefully so that I know exactly what to do. I will need to look at points as I listen because they will not be in the same _____ as I hear them.

B Complete each sentence about reading using one word only.

1. In the IELTS Reading Module, passages which are advertisements, leaflets or information pages will be clearly divided into sections. Texts will be clearly divided into _____.
2. Reading the _____ sentence, which is usually the first sentence, of each paragraph will help me to read more quickly. I will often be able to predict quite a lot about a text just by reading the _____ sentence.
3. I will understand a text better if I can quickly see what is _____ and what is opinion.
4. When you complete a summary, you will either need to use words from the text or choose words from a _____. If the words come from a _____, they will not always be words from the text. I should always look at what comes before and after a space in a summary so I can check that answers _____ grammatically.
5. I will read more quickly and understand texts better if I see how one word or phrase _____ back or forwards to another. I need to understand how _____ words, like 'it', 'this', 'there' and 'one', are used.

C Answer the questions (Y) yes or (N) no.

1. Has your listening and reading improved since the last review section? _____
2. Do you feel more confident about doing well in the tasks? _____
3. Are you dealing better with words and phrases that you don't know? _____
4. Are you happy with the number of correct answers you are achieving in the tasks? _____



Exam tip: Don't worry if your scores for some tasks are the same as they were earlier in the course. The tapescripts are getting longer. Vocabulary and grammatical structures are more challenging!

Writing

You will hear an interview with an IELTS examiner. He talks about marking compositions.

- A**  Look at the interviewer's first question and then listen to the first part of the interview. Mark these statements (T) true, (F) false or (NG) not given.

What is the difference between the Academic exam and the General Training exam in terms of the Writing Module?

1. The General Training writing exam is easier than the Academic writing exam. ☐
2. In the General Training writing exam, students need to write about graphs and charts. ☐
3. Not many students do well in the second part of the Academic writing exam. ☐
4. For General Training students, writing a letter is usually the easier of two tasks. ☐

- B**  Look at the interviewer's second question and then listen to the second part of the interview. Put the points into the order in which you hear them.

What do you look for when you mark an IELTS composition?

- ☐ A letter or composition should have paragraphs.
- ☐ The student should use the appropriate register.
- ☐ The student must use the right number of words.
- ☐ Points or ideas need to be linked with both reference words or linking words.
- ☐ The composition must be easy to read.
- ☐ Each paragraph should start with a topic sentence.
- ☒ 1 The student must answer the question.
- ☐ Points must be organized into a logical order.

- C**  Look at the interviewer's third question and then listen to the third part of the interview. Complete the summary below. Use no more than two words for each answer.

What about vocabulary, spelling and accurate grammar?

If students are aiming for a lower score in the IELTS exam, they do not need to use very (1) _____ vocabulary. They should try to use the (2) _____ or phrase if they know it, but it is important to keep things simple. They should only use words and phrases that they know how to use (3) _____. For students aiming for a lower score, it is more important to use (4) _____ grammatical structures accurately than to try to use complicated structures that they do not really know how to use.

- D** Read the tapescript on pages 302 and 303.

- E** Give yourself a mark out of ten for how much your writing has improved.

0 ————— 5 ————— 10

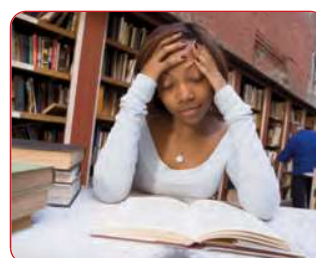
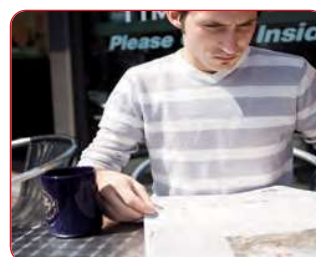
My writing has not
really improved at all.

My writing is much better
than it was at the beginning
of the course.

What next?

You've now completed two-thirds of the course. You've heard most of the different types of talk or conversation that you will hear in the Listening Module, and you've read most of the different types of text that you will have to read in the Reading Module. You've practised almost all of the task types for each Module. You should feel more confident about taking the exam now, but don't worry if there are still parts that you find difficult. There is plenty of time to practise those parts and to deal with any problems you are having. Here are some things that you should do now. Decide which ones you'd like to do first. Number them.

- ☐ Continue to speak English every time you get the opportunity. Now you know what sort of things the examiner will ask you in the spoken exam, practise talking about those things. If you have friends or relatives who speak good English, try to have short conversations with them that practise what you have been learning and try to use new vocabulary that you have learnt.
- ☐ There are lots of websites that have short clips with people speaking English. Even if you don't understand everything people say, you will pick out some words and phrases and become more familiar with the pronunciation patterns of the language. Watch a movie in English from time to time if you can. Continue to borrow CDs to listen to if you need extra practice with the Listening Module of the exam.
- ☐ Continue to read as much as you can. You should be able to follow more challenging texts now, so look at English newspapers and magazines more frequently. There are thousands of websites in English, and you can always find something that you are especially interested in. Continue to think about the organization of a text and note down new vocabulary that you think will be useful to remember. Try to use the vocabulary when you speak or write.
- ☐ As your English improves, you may feel that you want to learn and remember more vocabulary than is realistic. Make sure you learn and revise vocabulary that is useful and that you can use to communicate. As well as single new words, you should learn words that you already know used in new ways. You should learn how words go together to form common phrases and expressions.
- ☐ If you are still having difficulty with basic writing skills, continue to practise writing sentences and short paragraphs. Practise your spelling and punctuation. If you feel that your writing has improved, practise writing more compositions. Continue to look at as many model answers to exam questions as you can. This will help you know what to write and how to write it in the exam.



Go on to the next section of the Course Book. Make sure you practise all aspects of your English, but focus on what you are having problems with. Don't worry if you don't make progress in all areas at the same time.